

SparkBridge 90-Day Go-to-Market Sprint

MBA Program Owner Playbook, adjusted 2026-09-07

Objective: validate SparkBridge's market position with real Ignition integrators, convert qualified firms into Architecture Partners, and create the pipeline for the first production deployments.

Primary owner: MBA / Go-to-Market Program Lead. Duration: 90 days. Start: the day the MBA has the access checklist in section 25.

Changes from the 2026-09-07 draft

The draft was written without sight of what already exists. These are the adjustments; everything not listed stands as written.

1. Target list exists. 31 firms, contacts re-verified 2026-09-07, 2 to 3 named people per firm, email pattern per firm. Days 6 to 14 become "score and extend", not "build". Outreach can begin day 8.
 2. Partner program terms are ratified and live. Section 16 quotes them exactly. The MBA may quote those terms and nothing else.
 3. Sending. Assumption: the MBA sends outreach from their own greenguard-usa.com mailbox and LinkedIn, only to rows Dan has approved in the target sheet. Dan can revert to sending himself; the rest of the plan does not change.
 4. Success metrics. The "target" tier is the KPI set Dan accepted from the final pre-launch review. Minimum and exceptional tiers rescaled around it.
 5. Verticals. Four priority verticals, chosen from where the target list has depth. Others opportunistic. Re-rank at day 30 on replies.
 6. Training exists with a certification. Section 5 uses it instead of an ad hoc test.
 7. Honest-limits rules added (section 6). They are what makes the answer believed.
 8. Prices added (section 17). The live pricing page is the only source of truth.
 9. CRM conventions added (section 13). HubSpot properties and pipeline are fixed.
 10. Architecture review ownership named: Dan plus Claude. Pre-read before, written review within two business days after.
 11. Product calendar added (section 24). 3.0.0 lands mid-October inside the sprint.
 12. Touch 3 assets named. Nothing else is sent.
 13. Leadership review at day 30, 60 and 90 with Dan; Claude compiles the numbers.
 14. Access checklist added (section 25).
 15. The seven discovery questions from the SE training are the required opening set on every call.
-

1. Mission

The MBA's job is not primarily to sell software licenses in 90 days.

The job is to run a disciplined market-validation and partner-acquisition sprint answering:

1. Which integrators have the distributed-estate problem SparkBridge solves?
2. Which verticals have the strongest pain?
3. Which messages generate technical interest?
4. What objections repeatedly appear?
5. Where does SparkBridge fit into real architectures?
6. Which integrators can become long-term channel partners?
7. Can we create 1 to 2 serious production deployment opportunities?

Target outcome:

```
30 approved targets
      v
8 to 12 replies
      v
5 to 8 technical conversations
```

3 to 5 architecture reviews
2 to 3 Architecture Partners
1 to 2 production pilots
Production proof

2. Role definition

Title: SparkBridge Go-to-Market and Partner Development Lead.

This is not a cold-calling sales role. It combines market research, partner development, customer discovery, technical sales coordination, messaging validation, competitive intelligence, CRM discipline and go-to-market experimentation.

3. Core principle

Do not sell a module. Sell the conversation:

What changes when your Ignition deployment reaches 40 sites?

Core messaging, in the words the site uses:

- The problem: scaling Ignition creates backend complexity.
- The architecture: Edge moves data. Provider carries it. Host turns it into one system.
- The operating principle: publish once. Add consumers when you need them.
- The differentiation: MQTT is the transport. Operating the estate is the problem.
- The adoption story: nothing gets torn out on day one. Keep the plant. Replace the fragile connections between plants.

Never lead with "we have a cheaper MQTT module". That makes SparkBridge a commodity. Lead with architecture.

4. What success looks like at day 90

Metric	Minimum	Target (accepted KPIs)	Exceptional
Approved targets researched and scored	30	30	50
Personalized first touches sent	20	30	45
Replies	5	8 to 12	16+
Technical conversations	4	5 to 8	12+
Architecture reviews delivered	2	3 to 5	7+
Architecture Partners signed	1	2 to 3	4 to 5
Production pilots started	0	1 to 2	2, one in measured production
Objection database, vertical ranking, repeatable process	yes	yes	plus one written measured deployment

5. Week one: product immersion

Days 1 to 2: SparkBridge SE training

Use 02-training/SparkBridge-SE-Training-v1.pdf (16 modules) with the price cheat sheet open throughout. Order and timings are in the training README inside the PDF. Modules 00a and 00b cover Ignition itself; do not skip them.

Certification, as defined by the training: quiz passed at 80% or better (SparkBridge-SE-quiz.pdf), the demo script run once for Dan or an engineer, one discovery call shadowed.

Oral check before any outreach:

"An integrator has 35 remote Ignition sites, one central application, and wants to add a historian. Explain how SparkBridge changes the architecture."

The answer must contain: sites publish once over Sparkplug to a broker; Host builds one namespace; the historian is a consumer at Host (SparkVault) so nothing changes at the 35 sites; store-and-forward covers the WAN gaps on source timestamps; site 36 is one more Edge.

Also be able to explain SparkBridge in 30 seconds, 2 minutes and 10 minutes.

Day 3: website and sales asset immersion

Read in this order, all in 12-site-pages/ as PDFs and live on mqtt.greenguard-usa.com/sparkbridge: Overview (live), Compare, Architecture (Choose Your Starting Point table), Pricing, Partners (04-partner-program/), Roadmap, Benchmarks. Then the 40-site reference architecture PDF (03-reference-architecture/).

Required assignment, one page: what problem SparkBridge solves; who has it; what it replaces; what it does not replace; why an integrator would care; why they might not; when SparkBridge should not be recommended. Knowing when not to sell is the point.

Day 4: competitive training

Training module 08 and 10-competitive-cheat-sheet.md. The category distinction to hold:

```
MQTT modules -> connect Ignition to MQTT
SparkBridge -> architecture for operating distributed Ignition estates
```

Keep the cheat sheet as a living document. Every conversation adds a row or corrects one.

Day 5: messaging certification

Be able to answer, unprompted:

- "What is SparkBridge?" A distributed data architecture for Ignition that separates plant data production from the applications and systems that consume it.
- "Isn't this just MQTT?" MQTT is the transport, and the right one. SparkBridge is what remains after the transport: one namespace, consumers that scale on the shared stream, replay on source timestamps into history and warehouse, enrollment, fleet, policy.
- "Why not existing MQTT modules?" If the requirement is connecting Ignition to MQTT, they are a good answer and we say so. SparkBridge matters when many sites, independent consumers, fleet operations and governance have to grow without revisiting plants.
- "Do I have to replace my Ignition system?" No. Nothing gets torn out on day one.

6. Honest limits the MBA carries into every conversation

These are the caveats the site publishes. Say them before the prospect finds them.

- No published production reference yet. Every number was measured on named hardware with reproduction steps in the reference architecture. The partner program exists to produce the first case study.
- Never say "certified". The Sparkplug Compatible listing is in progress; we ran the TCK harness.
- Early access and pilot labels: SparkRecord (early access 0.1.0), SparkValidate (pilot), GitOps / Enterprise Governance (pilot). Buy the labeled products for what they do today.
- Enrollment in 2.9.0 issues certificates but the broker does not yet require the client certificate at connect. Say "certificate issuance", never "mTLS enforced". 3.0.0 closes this.
- Mixed-vendor Edge and Host pairing is by specification; we run the exact pairing on the bench before anyone buys.
- Modules are signed with our own code-signing certificate, not an Inductive Automation one; the gateway asks to trust it once.
- Team size: say it honestly if asked. Development is free with no time limit, so a prospect can prove everything on their own estate before spending.

Pattern: answer, then the caveat, then stop.

7. Days 6 to 14: score and extend the target list

The list exists: 06-targets/integrator-targets.csv, 31 firms, refreshed 2026-09-07 with 2 to 3 named people per firm, email pattern and confidence per firm, and Dan's approve column. Google Sheet "SparkBridge Partner Targets" in Drive mirrors it.

Days 6 to 10: score all 31 with the rubric in section 8 (columns score_*, score, tier are in the CSV, blank). Verify any row marked unverified or pattern before it goes out. Rows Dan has not approved are not contacted.

Days 11 to 14: extend to 50 using the same columns. Look for: significant Ignition practice, multi-site customer deployments, distributed SCADA, MQTT or Sparkplug experience, enterprise industrial customers, custom application work, long managed-support relationships. The research notes in 06-targets/integrator-targets-research-notes.md show the evidence standard.

Priority verticals, from where the list has depth and where the design partner offer already points:

1. Distributed manufacturing (DMC, Flexware, Corso, ATS, RoviSys, Tamaki)
2. Water, wastewater, utilities and renewables (SAGE, Perceptive, Brown, NeoMatrix, Ulteig, Vertech)
3. Data centers (Hanley, Thermo, BW Design Group, NFM, BIJC, Vertech)
4. Oil and gas (Streamline, CSE ICON, NFM)

Opportunistic: pharma and validated (SL Controls/NNIT, Agidens, 4IR), food and beverage, mining, logistics (no logistics-specific Ignition integrators surfaced in search).

8. Score every target

Criteria	Score
Large Ignition practice	0 to 5
Multi-site deployments	0 to 5
MQTT / Sparkplug experience	0 to 5
Target vertical fit	0 to 5
Enterprise customer evidence	0 to 5
Likely distributed architecture pain	0 to 5
Public technical sophistication	0 to 5

Maximum 35. Tier A 25 to 35: direct personalized outreach. Tier B 18 to 24: secondary outreach. Tier C under 18: monitor.

Most important question per firm: what evidence suggests this company has a distributed systems problem? Do not contact someone merely because they use Ignition.

9. Days 8 to 30: outreach sprint

Philosophy: no brochures, no feature dumps, no long introductions, no immediate demo ask. Lead with an architectural question. The objective is curiosity and a technical conversation.

Primary message (full text and follow-up in 07-outreach/):

What changes when your Ignition deployment reaches 40 sites?

We built SparkBridge around that question. Sites publish once, so applications, historians, warehouses and other consumers can be added centrally without revisiting every plant.

We are looking for a small group of experienced Ignition integrators to pressure-test the architecture against real distributed estates. If you have a topology worth discussing, we would like to compare approaches.

Rules: one named person per firm at a time, the firm-specific hook from the CSV in sentence one, plain text, no tracking pixels, UTM only on the two links. Dan approves the row before the first touch. Every send logged in HubSpot the same day.

10. Outreach sequence

Touch	When	Content
1 Architecture question	Day 0	Short personalized email or LinkedIn message. Goal: a reply.
2 Specific observation	Day 3 to 5	Reference their distributed project, industry, MQTT experience or multi-site work.
3 One technical asset	Day 8 to 10	Exactly one: Compare page, 40-site reference architecture PDF, Benchmarks page, or one finished article from 14-articles/. Not everything.
4 Partner program	Only after relevance is established	"We are forming a small group of Architecture Partners and thought your team may be a strong fit." Link to /sparkbridge/partners.

A "no thanks" closes the deal as lost and cancels the remaining touches. Silence after touch 4 goes to a 60-day hold.

11. The first discovery call

Integrator speaks 70%, SparkBridge 30%. Discovery, not demonstration.

Required opening set (SE training module 07), every call, answers into HubSpot before the call ends:

1. How many Ignition gateways, and which are redundant pairs? (shape)
2. How do sites reach the center today: Gateway Network, MQTT, VPN, nothing? (shape)
3. What is the busiest central box doing right now, CPU and memory? (the pain number)
4. What happens to history and alarms when a site's WAN drops?
5. How many consumers of site data exist, and who is asking for the next one?
6. Who builds a new site gateway and how long does it take?
7. Is there a broker already, and who owns it?

Then, as time allows: growth (at what site count does architecture become difficult; have customers added historians or warehouses later; have you revisited sites to add a consumer; what becomes painful after 20 sites), competitive (what MQTT stack, why, what you wish it did differently), validation (does SparkBridge solve a problem you actually meet; where does it not fit; what would stop you recommending it). Full script in 08-discovery-call-and-report.md.

Hand off to the architecture review for any estate over ten sites, any HA question, any broker the customer already runs, any 8.3-only feature.

12. Every conversation produces a structured report

Within 24 hours, in HubSpot on the contact and deal (template and field mapping in 08-discovery-call-and-report.md): account, architecture (site count, current shape, MQTT stack, central applications, existing consumers), pain (primary, secondary, business consequence, current workaround), SparkBridge fit (strong / moderate / weak / unknown), objections in the prospect's exact words, next step.

The intelligence database is worth more than the lead count.

13. CRM conventions (fixed)

- HubSpot contact properties: outreach_campaign = sparkbridge-fap-2026-09, outreach_segment = vertical, lifecycle_lead.
- One contact per named person, one company per firm.
- Deals: the "SparkBridge Partners" pipeline (create once in the HubSpot UI; the MCP integration cannot create pipelines) with stages contacted, call booked, review delivered, partner signed, pilot live, production measured. Until it exists, deals go in the default Sales Pipeline tagged "SparkBridge FAP". Deal created at first reply.
- Every deal carries: named owner, next action, next meeting date, architecture status, technical blocker, commercial blocker, target deployment date. No deal sits labeled "interested".

14. Architecture review program

This is the primary conversion mechanism. Offer: draw your estate before you buy anything. Intake is the mailto on mqtt.greenguard-usa.com/sparkbridge/architecture-review (site count, topology, tags per site, update rates, WAN type, history design, applications, pain points, Ignition versions).

SparkBridge delivers: current-state diagram, SparkBridge reference architecture, failure-domain analysis, migration path, rough sizing with the list price for that shape, known limitations and open questions.

Ownership:

- MBA: scheduling, intake, documentation, follow-up, CRM, opportunity progression.
- Dan plus Claude: Claude prepares a one-page pre-read from the intake (architecture number from the Architecture page, list price for the shape, honest limits, partner terms) at least one day before the call; Dan leads the technical conversation; Claude drafts the written review within two business days; Dan approves it before it goes out.

The written review is the deliverable that qualifies a firm as an Architecture Partner.

15. Days 31 to 60: convert conversations into reviews

By day 30 know: which verticals respond, which messages work, which objections repeat, which firms have genuine fit. Double down on evidence. If manufacturing produced five conversations and data centers none, move the effort. This is a market-discovery sprint, not a fixed campaign.

Build the objection library (09-objection-library.md): product, commercial, market, trust. Track objection, frequency, severity, response, product action. Review weekly with Dan.

16. Days 45 to 75: Architecture Partner conversion

Terms (ratified 2026-09-05, live at /sparkbridge/partners). Quote these and nothing else:

- Architecture Partner: invitation only, cap 10. Entry condition: one completed architecture review of an estate of 10 or more sites. Benefits: development licenses (free for everyone, stated so partners know), NFR production-grade key per module for the partner's demo estate renewed yearly, direct engineering access, 90-day deal registration, 20% off list, named escalation with a one-business-day reply on production issues, co-selling on request, one recorded training session per year, quarterly roadmap call.
- Founding Partner: the first five Architecture Partners to take a customer estate into measured production. 40% off list on that first production estate, NFR keys that never expire, shared priority support channel, a vote on public roadmap order, joint case study.
- No discount stacking. Volume pricing is Dan's call, not a discount the MBA offers.
- Design partners are end customers, not integrators: a separate unpublished 50% offer (05-design-partner-offer-INTERNAL.md) used through the integrator. Never quoted to an integrator as their own discount.

Ideal first partner: a technically strong Ignition integrator with a real distributed customer opportunity and enough engineering depth to challenge SparkBridge. One of those beats ten passive partners.

17. Prices the MBA may quote

Only from mqtt.greenguard-usa.com/sparkbridge/pricing; the cheat sheet PDF is a copy verified 2026-09-06. Per gateway, one-time, development free with no time limit, support optional at 20% of list per year, nothing per tag, device or client.

Shape, 40 sites	Required total	Support per year
Customer's own broker: 39 Edge + 1 Host	\$40,300	\$8,060
Provider HA pair + history: 39 Edge + 2 Provider + 2 Host + SparkVault	\$49,780	\$9,956
Complete operating architecture: above + FleetOps + Sentinel + GitOps	\$69,765	\$13,953

Site 41 is one more Edge, \$995. Never invent a per-tag number; explain the model once and show the 40-site example.

18. Production opportunity qualification

Score: real customer, multi-site, active project, architecture pain, executive support, technical fit, timeline under 12 months, each 0 to 5. Prioritize 25 or more.

19. Days 61 to 90: pipeline conversion

Conversation -> Architecture review -> Technical validation -> Partner discussion -> Customer opportunity -> Pilot ,

For each pilot agree the measurement plan up front (sites, tags per site, outage replay, consumer count) so the first write-up can use the same method as the Benchmarks page.

20. Weekly operating rhythm

- Monday: pipeline review (new targets, outreach, responses, meetings, reviews, opportunities) and product intelligence review (objections, competitive findings, feature requests, website confusion).
- Tuesday to Thursday: research, outreach, discovery calls, follow-up, review coordination.
- Friday: one-page weekly report to Dan (11-reports/weekly-report-template.md).

21. Leadership review at day 30, 60 and 90

Present evidence, not activity. Claude compiles the numbers from HubSpot beforehand.

Bad: "I sent 80 emails." Good: "Eight integrators responded. Six immediately understood the 40-site problem. Three use remote tag providers. The repeated objection is new-vendor risk, not pricing."

Dan asks: what did we learn, what changed, what should we stop, what should we double down on, is this a product issue or a messaging issue.

22. KPI dashboard

Leading: target quality, personalized outreach, response rate, discovery calls, architecture reviews. Validation: problem acknowledged, fit, partner interest, technical follow-up requested. Commercial: qualified opportunity, pilot, deal registration, partner agreement. Strategic: most promising vertical, most common architecture, most common objection, most common competitor, feature gaps. Template in 11-reports/.

23. What the MBA should not do

- Become a generic SDR: mass automated email, LinkedIn spam, feature dumps, "just checking in", volume as the metric.
- Become product support: document questions, coordinate escalation.
- Promise roadmap items. Never "we can add that". Instead: "I will document that requirement and have the product team evaluate where it fits." Any "when does X ship" goes to the public roadmap page, which has no dates on purpose.
- Discount. New-vendor risk is answered with architecture access, engineering support, NFR licensing, pilot support and transparent evidence, not price.

24. Product calendar during the sprint

- Today: SparkBridge 2.9.0 released 2026-09-06 (both Ignition lines). SparkRecord 0.1.0 early access. SparkS7 0.2.1.
- Mid-October (target week of 2026-10-12): SparkBridge 3.0.0, a breaking release that partners will prove: manual-ack transport, client-certificate enforcement, two-round enrollment. Partners starting in the sprint install 3.0.0, not 2.9.0.
- After: SparkRecord 0.2.0, SparkInject 0.2.0, SparkNotify 0.3.0.
- Externally: no dates. Internally: do not sell 2.9.0 enrollment claims that 3.0.0 corrects (section 6).

25. Access checklist (before day 1)

- greenguard-usa.com mailbox and calendar; a booking link for review calls.
- HubSpot seat with edit rights; the "SparkBridge Partners" pipeline created.
- Edit access to the Google Sheet "SparkBridge Partner Targets" and the Drive folder Claude uploads / Industrial & Drivers.
- LinkedIn from a personal account with the company listed.
- This bundle, and the SparkBridge repo docs/gtm/ if the MBA will edit the source files.
- A standing 30-minute Monday slot with Dan and the Friday report address.

26. Required deliverables at day 90

1. Market validation report: who has the problem, which verticals care, at what scale pain appears, the strongest buying trigger.
2. Target market ranking: vertical, integrator type, customer architecture, deployment size.
3. Objection report: frequency, severity, recommended response, product implications.
4. Competitive intelligence report: Cirrus Link, Gateway Network, HiveMQ, EMQX, Cedalo, custom architectures, as heard in the field.
5. Partner pipeline: active, qualified, in review, production opportunity, closed / no fit.
6. Product feedback report: critical gap, strategic opportunity, nice-to-have, off-architecture distraction (apply the four themes in 13-product-themes-INTERNAL.md).
7. Recommended GTM strategy, from evidence, not assumptions.

27. Timeline

Days	Phase	Output
1 to 7	Learn: training, certification, competitive, messaging	Can explain and position SparkBridge independently
6 to 14	Map: score 31, extend to 50, tier	Ranked, approved target list
8 to 45	Discover: personalized outreach, conversations	Validated pain points, repeatable messaging
31 to 60	Validate: architecture reviews, technical validation	Real-world architecture fit
45 to 75	Partner: partner discussions, production opportunities	2 to 3 serious partner relationships
61 to 90	Convert: alignment, pilot	1 to 2 credible production opportunities

Final instruction

Your job is not to prove SparkBridge is amazing. Your job is to discover where SparkBridge is genuinely valuable. Be curious. Ask technical questions. Listen more than you pitch. Document objections exactly. Look for patterns. Do not defend the product when someone says it does not fit; that answer is valuable.

After 90 days, success means the company knows who to sell to, what problem to lead with, what objections to solve, which partners matter, and where the first production deployments will come from.